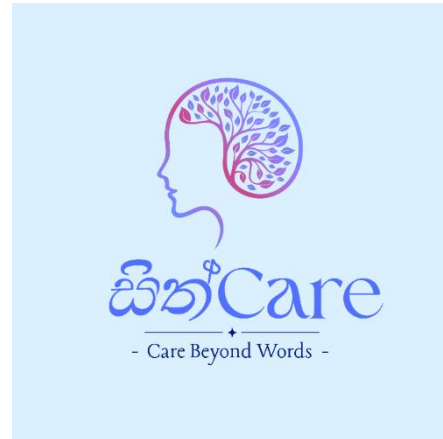




SENG 31242 – System Design Project

Persona 01

Interview Transcript

SithCare Channelling App

Group 10



Interview Transcript of Mental Health Patients – SithCare Channeling App

Date of Interview: 23/05/2026 (Saturday)

Location: Conducted remotely via Zoom

Interviewer: Project Member, SithCare Chanelling App

Interviewee: Persona 1, a 21-year-old, Final Year Business Undergraduate

Interview Objective: To explore mental health patients' experiences and requirements for improved digital support.

Consent: The interviewee has consented to the interview being recorded and transcribed for internal documentation.

Source Link: [Persona 01 Interview](#)

Opening Statement

“Thank you for participating. As a team, we are developing a mental health support application to improve accessibility and support for patients. Your responses are confidential and will only be used for academic purposes. You may skip any question or stop at any point if uncomfortable. There are no right or wrong answers; we simply want to understand your experience.”

Section 1: Background Information (Ice Breaker)

Q1. Could you tell us a little about yourself? (Age range, occupation/student status, and anything you'd like to share about your lifestyle.)

***Purpose:** Understand demographics and routines.*

Answer: I'm 21, and currently a final year undergraduate. I'm an ambivert. I enjoy my time mostly when I stay with my partner. Most of the time, I find it difficult to maintain things in my daily routine, but I push through. I think I have made myself more isolated and more cautious after realizing how severe my condition is getting.

Q2. Are you comfortable sharing your mental health diagnosis or concerns?

(Follow-up)

- When were you diagnosed?
- How did you realise something was wrong?
- Who diagnosed you?



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Purpose: Understand conditions.

Answer: Yes, I am comfortable. I was diagnosed with Generalized Depression Disorder at 18, and then a few months ago, I was diagnosed with Major Depressive Disorder (MDD), Bipolar Disorder, and Borderline Personality Disorder (BPD). I'm getting treated by my psychiatrist, and I've also been in psychotherapy with my therapist. At first, I used to feel empty, emotional, irritated, and overwhelmed. I get angry at the smallest thing; I overthink a lot. I had panic attacks often. I couldn't have any meals properly as I felt nauseous often. I was exhausted by these.

Q3. What symptoms or struggles do you experience because of your condition?

Answer: I have social anxiety, and I struggle with insomnia, panic attacks, and pass outs. I had a really low appetite. Shortness of breath and rapid heartbeat. I barely had the motivation to do anything. Most of the time, I felt empty and emotionally numb. At some point, I have lost hope in things, too.

Section 2: Current Mental Healthcare Experience

Q4. Can you describe your experience seeking mental health support?

Answer: Finding a proper psychiatrist was difficult. I was not able to find any recommendations properly. I was very cautious about what type of person the doctor would be because I wanted the doctor to understand my situation, not just prescribe medicine to me.

Q5. What challenges do you face when booking appointments? (based on personal experience)

Answer: Usually, not being able to know suitable specialists and their availability at hospitals. Also, the distance to the specific hospital is something that I would like to know as well.

Q6. Have you ever delayed seeking help? Why?

Answer: Yes, I have. Mostly because I never thought that anything would fix how I feel and did not want to take pills.

Q7. How comfortable are you discussing mental health openly?



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Answer: I don't open up to people that easily, because most people don't really understand how mental health affects someone's life. I'm somewhat selective when talking about it. Some take it very lightly, stating that others have worse situations than you. Which feels like no point in opening up to others, and I tend to keep things for myself.

Section 03: Technology Usage & Digital Behavior

Q8. Do you currently use any apps/websites related to mental health?

(Follow Up) What do you like/dislike about them?

Answer: Yes, I do use appointment apps for my channelings. But I don't use any other mental health-related apps because they are not up to my liking. Most of them have complicated tasks. Some require maintaining streaks by completing tasks, or even unpleasant or complicated interfaces with many graphics. Not minimalistic.

Q9. What frustrates you about existing healthcare or appointment systems? (Any improvements?)

Answer: I would say the struggle to find available hospitals when booking specialists. And there are no tracking systems for ongoing patient token numbers; to know how many are ahead of a certain token number.

Q10. If a mental health app existed, what would make you trust it?

Answer: I prefer to have trusted, verified specialists. Protected Privacy. Maybe Authentication for Security.

Section 4: Therapist Matching (Aimed at therapist rec. Qs.)

Q11. When looking for a therapist, what information matters most?

Answer: I would like to look into the experience and the personality, mainly. Gender would be another factor, but as long as they have the understanding mindset, it would not matter significantly.

Q12. What questions should an app ask before recommending a therapist?



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Answer: It should be asking about what type of concern you have, where it is related to abuse, sexual harassment, family issues, or relationship issues, etc. I prefer it if it asks about the symptoms as well. Because personally, I think it would help to measure the severity of the condition.

Section 5: Emergency & Crisis Situations

Q13. Have you experienced a mental health crisis? Only if comfortable

Answer: Yes, I have. I've had a lot. Such as panic attacks, passive and impulsive suicidal thoughts, self-harming urges, constant emotional breakdowns, and feeling lightheaded, often leading to pass-outs. etc.

Q14. During emergencies, what support would help you most?

Answer: I prefer to have emergency bookings with my therapist. Or have a call with someone, I personally call someone whom I trust a lot. But if it's not for that person, I might not have anyone to talk to during an emergency.

Q15. Would you use emergency same-day booking? Why?

Answer: Yes, definitely I would. I think it would be very helpful when you are in urgent need of seeing your therapist or psychiatrist, as any app has that feature.

Section 6: Anonymous Community & Peer Support

Q16. Would anonymous support groups help you? Why?

Answer: Yeah, I think so. Because it included people who have been in the same place as me, I would not need to worry about feeling judged, and it would even help me to feel understood.

Q17. What concerns would you have about anonymous communities?

Answer: Maybe getting encouraged to do something negative. And if anything, harmful or offensive happens, I'd like to have the authority to report the specific incident or the person who's related to it.



Section 7: Privacy & Security (As mental health data is sensitive)

Q18. What privacy concerns would stop you from using a mental health app?

Answer: I would have concerns about whether the other end of the application has access to my personal entries. Or even not having a passcode to certain features, such as diary entries, if available.

Q19. Would anonymity encourage you to seek support earlier?

Answer: Yes, I think it would be, because I would not like to share my personal details with anyone, as these days we use a lot of social media, so my name would be exposed by that. And also, anonymity should go both ways and not feel pressured to expose my details just to discuss my condition.

Final Question (Ending)

Q20. Is there anything you wish healthcare providers or technology developers understood better about mental health patients?

Answer: Honestly, no one should judge another person by the appearance of the patient; someone might look very well-mannered, very organized, clean and still struggle to push through even to do the smallest thing daily. And on the other hand, someone might look like they are all over the place, and not even be able to clean themselves, and be very isolated, and also struggle to get through their daily routine. And healing takes time, and it depends on person to person; some people might take a long time, such as 4-5 years or even more, and for some it might take a short period of time, such as 10-12 months or even less. Recovery is possible, but it is not linear; recovery has ups and downs, and it'll feel great at some point and in another minute, it will feel like going through hell. So be patient with people. And be understanding towards them. Don't badmouth or talk behind their back or even underestimate their struggle.

Closing Statement

“Thank you for sharing your experiences. Your insights will help us design a more accessible and supportive mental health application for people who may face similar challenges.”